

To Fix:

Normal attack visual and animation don't line up, make them match so its clear. Normal attack (and animation) should be in front of you, not overhead. Maybe charged attack will be overhead.

Your swing direction is locked to the direction you swing until its over, so if you turn around you'll just move backward. Is that fine?

Add 1 lore pip to the Rift to have a total of 18 lore pips

Global Rules (Apply to All)

- **Fracture Pips:** 4 total. Gain $\frac{1}{3}$ pip per melee hit on an enemy.
- **Limit Break (Lv4):** Costs 3 filled Fracture Pips to activate. Lasts 6 seconds.
 - Grants **complete immunity to knockback** and **immunity to environmental hazards** (spikes, pits, lava) for the duration.
 - **You CANNOT gain Fracture Pips** from hits during a Lv4 Limit Break or while Stillpoint is active (prevents infinite chaining).
- **Enemy Super Armor:** Enemies are immune to knockback during their attack wind-ups.
- **Memory Resonance:** One place in the map allows you to reallocate all your lore pips, but only once. Suggest a good place for it.

To add

None of these are currently displayed in the HUD. You'll need to add:

- A charge meter overlay (near the player or on the HUD)
- A Limit Break timer (countdown)
- A visual indicator for Lifesteal cap (maybe a heart icon with a number)

The inventory UI will need a complete overhaul to accommodate all of the upgrade screens in a readable way.

You have new mechanics that need visual feedback:

- Charge meter (for persistent charge) — needs a UI element (maybe under the player's feet, like cooldown rings, or on the HUD)
- Limit Break timer (6s countdown) — needs a visible bar
- Beam charge indicator (if it's a separate input, show when it's charging)
- Gravity Ball (visual entity — that's in-game, not HUD, but needs to be visible)
- Lifesteal cap indicator (currently no UI for this — should show somewhere)

Global Combat Rules

Rule 0: The Level 4 Lock

- You can only unlock **ONE Level 4 upgrade per playthrough**.
- Found in an optional endgame region. Once chosen, the other abilities are permanently unable to get upgraded to level 4, unless they go to Memory Resonance.
- **Design implication**: This forces meaningful build identity.

Rule 1: Charged Attack is a Persistent State (Highest Priority Overlay)

- Holding **X** starts a charge. The charge **persists** through dashes, jumps, tether pulls
- You can hold **X** *while* pressing (Dash), (Jump), or (Tether). The charge meter continues building in the background.
- Release **X** to swing.
- **Visual Indicator**:
 - **Tap** (0–5f): Normal swing
 - **Medium Hold** (6–25f): Charged Attack (Yellow Glow)
 - **Full Hold** (26f+): If you have the **Lv4 Strength unlock**, this activates your Limit Break *on release* (Blue glow)
- For other abilities with a hold variation after some level (graviton surge, shard shot) the charge persists. However, you can only charge one ability at a time.

Rule 2: Stillpoint is a "Lockdown" State (Overwrites Ability Access)

- Activating Stillpoint (costs 1 or 3 Pips, depending on tap/hold).
- **While Stillpoint is active**:
 - The player moves at **100% normal speed** (at Lv1+; Lv0 may have a 50% speed penalty).
 - All enemies, projectiles, and hazards slow down (60%–90% slow, depending on level).
 - **LOCKED**: Graviton Surge (**G**) (tap version) is **completely disabled**. If you press that, nothing happens.
 - **ALLOWED**: Jumping, walking, and **Charged Attacks (Hold Z)**. The Lv4 Limit Break (if you chose Strength) can still be activated via full-charge Z during Stillpoint. Tap Shard Shot (**V**) is still possible, but they are slowed too.
 - **Charged attack charge speed is capped at normal rate.**
 - **All other abilities are allowed, but are slowed as well (projectiles slow, tether is slow, etc)**

Rule 3: Standard State Input Priority (Outside Stillpoint)

The Final, Clean Input Logic

One thing at a time

1. **Discrete "Press" actions (Tap Attack, Tap Graviton Surge, Tap Void Tether, Tap Shard Shot)** are **ignored** if you are currently in the middle of *any* other action (swing recovery, dash, tether pull, etc.). No queue. If you press it 1 frame too early, nothing happens—you have to press it again after the recovery ends. *This rewards precise timing.*
2. **The Charged Attack (Hold Z)** is an **exception**, but a consistent one: since you're *holding* a button (an analog state, not a discrete press), the game continuously checks for it. This means holding Z *does* persist through dashes, jumps, and tether pulls—as you already wrote in Rule 1—because the "holding" state is active the entire time. When the current action ends, if Z is still held, the charge starts immediately. This is consistent: you aren't *pressing* a button during a recovery, you are *already holding* it.
3. **Phase Dash (F)** remains the designated **interrupt/cancel** button. Pressing it during *any* action (swing, charge, tether pull) immediately cancels that action and fires the dash. This gives the player a universal "panic button" escape, which is crucial for fairness in a fast game. Everything else respects the "no queue" rule.

When Stillpoint is **not** active, the game reads your inputs in this strict order per frame:

Priority	Input	Behavior
1 (Cancel)	Phase Dash	Instantly interrupts <i>anything</i> (attack, charge, tether). Fires the dash. Your charge is dropped if you were holding Z.
2 (Continuous)	Charged Attack (Hold Z)	Tracked continuously. If you are holding Z, the charge <i>does not increase</i> while you are in an action (dash/swing), but the <i>hold state</i> is remembered. The

moment the action ends, if Z is still held, the charge resumes building. This also applies to other charges attacks of higher level graviton surge and shard sho. However, you can only charge one thing at a time.

3 (Discrete)	Attack Tap (Z), Graviton Surge (G), Void Tether (T), Shard Shot (V)	Strictly ignored if the player is currently in the middle of <i>any</i> other action (attack windup/recovery, dash, tether pull). No buffer, no queue. If you want it to happen, you must press it <i>after</i> the recovery ends.
--------------	--	---

1. Strength (Normal & Charged Attacks)

Base ability: Standard slash (Z) and hold-to-charge heavy attack.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Melee slash (18f cooldown, 1 dmg). Charged attack (40f charge, 2 dmg, moderate knockback).
Lv 1	Attack speed +15% (18f → 15f).
Lv 2	Damage +20% (1 → 1.2). Charged attack knockback +30% .
Lv 3	Incoming knockback on player -30% . Damage +25% (total now +45%; 1 → 1.45 dmg).
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : Attack speed +25%, Damage +50% (total 1.95 dmg), zero knockback, hazard immunity. Melee becomes a 3-hit combo (slash → slash → heavy slam). Charged attacks launch enemies into walls for +1 bonus wall-bounce damage .

2. Phase Dash

*Base ability: Found in Mirror Veil (C). Leaves a stunning echo at the **start** location.*

Level	Effect
-------	--------

Lv 0	Phase Dash (F). Dashes horizontally . Leaves an echo at the start location that stuns enemies for 30 frames .
Lv 1	Dash becomes 8-directional (aim with WASD/arrows). <i>Applies to the regular dash (C) too.</i>
Lv 2	Echo stun duration +30% (30f → 40f).
Lv 3	When you swing your sword, the echo attacks once from its position (deals 50% of your normal damage), then fades.
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : The echo becomes similar to a Stand (follows you). It mirrors your every melee attack (deals 100% damage), zero knockback, hazard immunity. Effectively doubles your melee DPS for 6 seconds.

3. Shard Shot

Base ability: Fire a single shard projectile (V).

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Fires 1 shard. Deals 1 damage.
Lv 1	Damage +25% (1 → 1.25).
Lv 2	Fires 2 shards simultaneously (slight horizontal spread).
Lv 3	Beam Attack : Hold V to charge. Fires a piercing laser (deals 2 damage, passes through enemies). Costs 1 Fracture Pip if held longer than 1 second. Tap variation remains
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : Your melee swings are replaced with Shard Blasts (glowing projectiles, 150% damage). Hold V for the Beam—it now deals 3 damage and pierces infinitely. Zero knockback, hazard immunity.

4. Stillpoint

Base ability: Tap (1 pip) for a short dodge-window; Hold (3 pips) for a long slow. Lifesteal cap starts at 1 HP per use.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Tap (1 Pip): 25 frames (0.4s) of 60% slow. Hold (3 Pips): 90 frames (1.5s) of 60% slow. Lifesteal cap = 1 HP .
Lv 1	Duration +25% (Tap → 31f, Hold → 112f). Lifesteal cap stays 1.
Lv 2	Lifesteal cap increases to 2 HP .
Lv 3	Slow increases to 90% (almost complete stop). Lifesteal cap increases to 3 HP .
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State: On activation, time stops fully for 2 seconds (enemies/projectiles freeze). For the remaining 4 seconds, time is slowed to 90%. Lifesteal cap increases to 4 HP . Zero knockback, hazard immunity.

5. Graviton Surge

Base ability: Flip gravity (G) for 3 seconds. Costs 1 Pip.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Reverses gravity for 3s. Enemies slamming into the ceiling/floor take 0 damage (just a stun).
Lv 1	Duration +1s (4s total). Enemies take 1 damage when they slam into the ceiling or floor.
Lv 2	Hold G to create a "Gravity Ball" that pulls nearby enemies toward it. <i>Tap duration increases to 5s.</i>
Lv 3	Gravity Ball explodes on release (deals 4 damage , 300% knockback). <i>Tap duration increases to 6s.</i>
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State: Gain Flight (fly freely, ignoring gravity). The Gravity Ball pulls enemies 50% faster and deals 6 damage on explosion. Zero knockback, hazard immunity. During Enhanced State, knockback is increased (200%). +1 bonus wall-bounce damage .

6. Void Tether

Base ability: Grappling hook (T). Costs 1 Pip. Pulls enemies to you, or pulls you to walls.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Standard tether. Pulls 1 target. No added effect.
Lv 1	Tether range +30% .
Lv 2	Tether becomes Electrified . When the enemy reaches you, they take +1 bonus damage and are stunned for 15 frames.
Lv 3	Pull speed +50% . The electrical stun arcs/chains to 1 nearby enemy (small AoE stun).
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : Tether costs 0 Pips to cast with 1.5s cooldown. Inflicts Fire (spreads to nearby enemies) dealing 2 damage per second for 3 seconds on the reeled-in target. Zero knockback, hazard immunity.

Considerations for Enemy-editor etc

What's Missing (The Attack Plan Integration)

Your Player Attack Plan adds **new player capabilities** that fundamentally change what enemies need to be tuned against:

New Player Mechanic	Enemy System Impact
Persistent charge (hold Z through dashes)	Enemies need longer windups or more aggressive gap-closing. A charging player is a moving threat—enemies that stand still become punching bags.
8-directional Phase Dash	Your ComposedEnemy attack hitboxes assume the player approaches from left/right. A player can now dash <i>up</i> into an enemy's blind spot. Enemies need vertical coverage in their hitboxes or anti-air attacks.
Stillpoint as a "lockdown" state	Your counters system only checks for phase_dash , shard_shot , melee_parry , stillpoint (cancel). It doesn't yet model the player fully .

Limit Break (Lv4)	6 seconds of "zero knockback, hazard immunity, and dramatically increased damage/speed" means enemies need counterplay to a player who is essentially invincible and hyper-aggressive. Your rage system is a good start, but it's a <i>reaction</i> to the player's damage, not a proactive anti-ult tool.
Graviton Surge & Void Tether	These don't exist in the player code yet, but when they do, enemies need dedicated counters (Gravity Anchor, Absorber Husk, etc.). Your <code>COUNTER_EFFECTS</code> has placeholders for <code>graviton_surge</code> (null_field) but no implementation—and no playtesting to know if those counters feel fair.
Void Tether (grapple pull)	If a player can pull an enemy toward them, enemies need some form of "anti-pull" or a punish for being yanked into melee range. Your <code>counter_stance</code> is a good start, but not every enemy should have it. I'm thinking about adding a "tether grab" where some enemies might catch the tether, and so the player is dragged to them instead

Additionally, maybe there should be some combos: Think about these:

1. Tether Slam

Input	<code>T</code> (Void Tether) → instantly press <code>Z</code> (Attack)
Effect	If the Tether connects, your attack comes out 50% faster and deals +50% damage (1.5x) to the pulled enemy.
Visual	The enemy flies toward you; your sword swing starts mid-pull, connecting the frame they arrive.
Why it works	The charge persists through the Tether, so you can even hold <code>Z</code> <i>before</i> pressing <code>T</code> —the Tether fires, pulls them in, and the heavy attack releases automatically on arrival.
Feeling	Rewards aggressive ranged engagement. Turns Void Tether from "just repositioning" into a combo starter.

2. Dash-Cancel Overhead

Input	C (Phase Dash) → press Z (Attack) mid-dash (during the 8-frame dash window)
Effect	Your character swings during the dash. The hitbox drags behind you (horizontal coverage). Deals standard damage, but has extended horizontal reach (the sword trails behind).
Why it works	Since Charge Attack persists through dashes, you can hold Z <i>before</i> dashing, and the swing will release automatically at the end of the dash. But tapping Z mid-dash gives you a faster, lower-commitment dash-swing.
Feeling	Turns your dash from a defensive escape into an offensive approach tool. Very Smash Bros.

3. Gravity Spike

Input	G (Graviton Surge) → instantly press Hold Z (Charged Attack)
Effect	If you activate Gravity Spike on the exact frame you flip gravity, your next Charged Attack slams straight down (regardless of your facing direction). Deals 2× damage to anything below you. If you're upside-down, it slams "down" relative to the new gravity.
Why it works	The charge persists through the gravity flip, so you can start charging, press G, and release the heavy slam as soon as you're upside-down.
Feeling	Punishes enemies on the ground (or ceiling) immediately after a gravity shift. Turns a positional ability into a burst-damage finisher.

Any more combos? Or should there be no combos?

Finally, we are considering a three ability loadout. Consider the number of buttons

z jump

x attack

c dash

f phase dash

v shard shot

q stillpoint

g grav surge

t void tether (though void tether is fully optional and depends on your choice)

Maybe there is too much for the player to do. Perhaps we should make it so you choose which three abilities you have (not including charged attack obviously) (you can choose at an anchor i guess) Is this okay? Then your first ability is a, second is v, third is s, or something. Easily

quickswapped at an anchor.

Or, it could even be a two ability loadout. Just can't be a four since that only hurt void tether choosers, but maybe its okay.

Or, it could be Contextual Actions (Direction + Button), like up + v =is one ability and down + v is another.

Or just keep it.

Look at all the options carefully, what do you suggest?